



Dridex Malware

Avira is still trying to find the responsible party for its whitehack and public installer file mixup with no success. <http://dgit.in/DriHack>



Intex launched

iBall launched iBall Cobalt 5.5F Youva with 4G connectivity and 5.5 inch display only at 10,999 targeting the youth. <http://dgit.in/Cobalt55F>

From the labs

Around a hundred engineers have come together in Hyperloop Transportation Technologies (HTT) to work on the hyperloop technology. They collaborate with each other by crowdsourcing through weekly teleconferences.

HTT is working smartly and has recently partnered with Oerlikon Leybold Vacuum, a company which specialises in vacuum technology, and also with Aesom, a company with which Space X is already in a collaboration with. In January 2016, HTT applied for a permit to begin construction of a test track in Quay Valley, California.

Hyperloop technologies (HT)

The other startup in the development of the fifth mode of transport is Hyperloop Technologies. They created quite a flutter when, in December 2015, they announced that they would be conducting an open air propulsion test, north of Las Vegas. While this test was itself an important landmark, the point of even greater significance here was that it was done with the Nevada Government's backing. This is quite significant as they have a vast resource and, in the past, government backing has resulted in a lot of technologies that we use in our everyday lives – the touchscreen tech used in phones is an example of technology research that was funded by American and European governments.

HT's Blade Runner test rig allows testing in speeds ranging from subsonic thru supersonic, and is powered by two 2,000 CFM (Cubic Feet per Minute) Vacuum pumps – the speed at which it can remove air from the system. The rotor in its levitation rig achieves surface speeds in excess of 300 m/s.

The head of the system, the command centre, called The Tube Lab is a fully equipped mobile command centre built into a cargo container cargo, it comes with equipment to collect hardware data and process it into useful information used for further development of the system.

Advantages

The most obvious advantage is faster travel, because when you travel at faster than 1000 kmph, you're basically travelling much faster than subsonic

aircraft can travel. The supersonic Concorde may have travelled at over 2,000 kmph, but it was just bad economics per person.

The second biggest advantage is cost. Today, you pay ridiculous amounts to travel long distances. The cost of travel is directly proportional to the distance and speed at which you want to travel. Estimates of the costs of hyperloop travel work out to about \$20 for a one-way 350-mile (600 km) journey. That's the distance of Goa to Bengaluru, or Pune to Hyderabad, or New Delhi to Jodhpur, in just 35 minutes, and costing only Rs 1,350! That's just a little more expensive

this one, and it would be easy to find and attack a weak spot in a 600 km vacuum tube.

There are high costs involved in the beginning. It's estimated that a 600 km line would cost about \$7.5 billion (Rs 51,500 crore). Although Space X has calculated that, if done right, private industries owning a hyperloop implementation could earn as much as 300 million USD a year! However, this is more likely to be a government-backed initiative.

A really big drawback is the fact that the current designs have amounted in really claustrophobic



A future hyperloop loading area where you board a pod?

than what we would pay for an AC bus ticket, except that the bus would take over 12 hours! That's not all, since hyperloop pods are contained in partial-vacuum tubes, travelling at high speeds, they're completely isolated and never affected by bad weather.

Since the system is powered by electricity produced by solar panels mounted on the tube itself, the hyperloop can actually give back to the grid, and certainly won't be affected by power failures of the grid – a huge boon in a place like India.

Challenges

Obviously, security is a major concern. Terror attacks target systems like

cabins. Although toilets may not really be required for a 30 minute journey, there might be a need for a few only because of the sickness passengers might feel when being locked in a small metal tube.

If an accident were to occur, there is no doubt it will be spectacular – there are vacuums and hollow tubes being shot at another city at over 1000+ kmph, and even the failure of a single system will result in catastrophe.

Whatever the case, we need to seriously consider any tech that will make the world a smaller place by letting us travel further and faster than ever before. Write in and let us know your thoughts on this...